



Cake Wallet

Putting the “punk” back in “solarpunk”

About me

- Freedom tech maximalist
- Host of the Opt Out podcast
- COO of Cake Wallet, a privacy-centric, self-custodial, open-source multi-crypto wallet
- Cautious Ethereum user





WTH is “solarpunk”?

“Solarpunk” is a bright, self-confident, and future-oriented perspective on the world consistent with many Ethereum builders approach.

But what if it’s *too* bright and optimistic?

Lunarpunk... a bit too dark?

Inspired by the great Rachel Rose O'Leary, Lunarpunk is the shadow-self of solarpunk.

> *[Lunarpunks] are preparing for war, and building privacy-enhanced tooling to protect their communities.*

But has it gone too far into pessimism and cynicism?



Finding the nuance



The sweet-spot, as always, is somewhere in the middle, united by the original philosophy of the cypherpunks:

- *“Privacy is necessary for an open society in the electronic age.”*
- *“We cannot expect governments, corporations, or other large, faceless organizations to grant us privacy out of their beneficence.”*
- *“Cypherpunks write code.”*

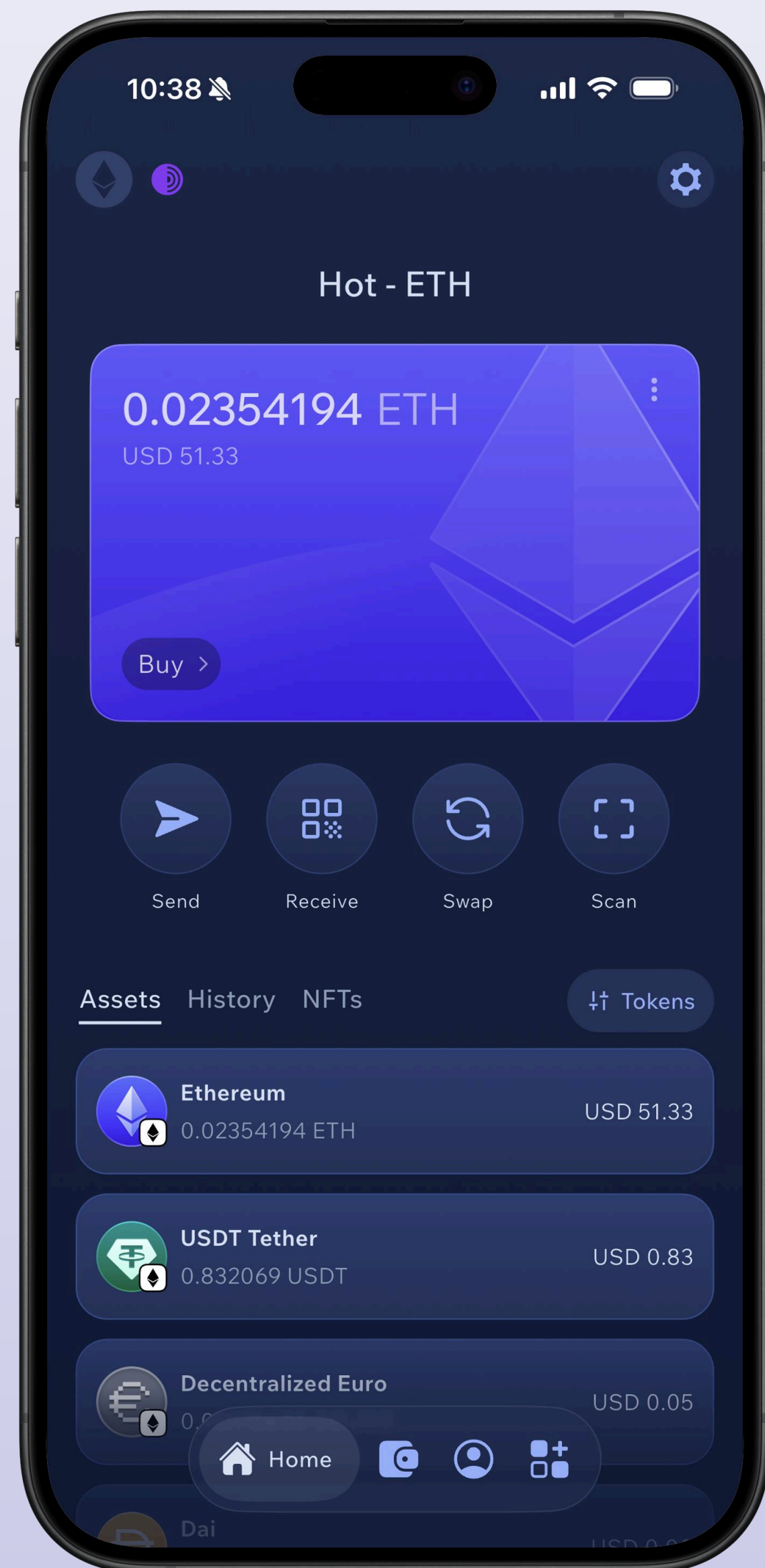
I call this “optimistic pragmatism.”

Building in the middle

Approaching what we build from the middle gives us the best of both worlds:

- Assume that freedom tech will empower individuals in new ways
- Assume that governments seek ultimate power, and that power corrupts
- Build to serve the individual and protect from adversaries
- The more individuals we pull together using freedom tech, the weaker authoritarians become





Getting practical

- Targeting self-custody and self-sovereignty at all costs
- Implementing easy-to-use privacy tools like Tor for all connections
- Build privacy tools that tilt the balance of power to the individual, no matter the cost
- Incentivize private behavior through good UX, strong defaults, and gentle prompts

Building bravely

One of those who built in the middle?
Roman Storm, co-founder of Tornado Cash,
who was falsely convicted by the US DoJ
but is still fighting via the appeals process.

Don't forget about him! Learn more and
donate 🙌

#FreeRomanStorm



Thank you!

Learn more about what we're building at cakewallet.com, or scan the QR code to go straight there.

Have a great rest of your EthCC!

